

BeTogether

Trust, Safety & Ratings

Simple Guide — Fraud Prevention, Reporting, and How Ratings Affect Rankings

Covers: reporting no-shows/fraud/misconduct, how blocking a user already works,
and a new rating system that rewards good providers with better visibility.

Status: **Proposal for review — nothing built yet**

1. The Big Picture — Two Connected Features

A. Reporting & Blocking (Fraud Prevention)

A way for a customer or provider to flag a problem — a provider who never showed up, someone behaving inappropriately, or suspected fraud — so the platform can review it and, if needed, block the account involved.

B. Ratings & Rankings

After a job is completed, the customer rates the provider and leaves feedback. Providers with better ratings show up higher when customers are browsing or comparing Offers — a direct incentive to do good work.

✓ Good news — blocking a user already works today

The platform already has a working "block/unblock" system for admins, and it's already enforced everywhere: once an admin blocks someone, that person is immediately signed out and cannot log back in or take any action until unblocked. **We don't need to build this part — we only need to build the reporting flow that feeds into it**, so admins know when to use it.

2. Reporting a Problem — Full Flow

Either the customer or the provider on a booking can file a report. Not every report is equally urgent, so reports are split into two levels:

Standard reports

Example: "The provider hasn't shown up in 3 days." Goes into a normal review queue — an admin looks at it and decides within a reasonable time.

Urgent reports

Example: harassment, inappropriate requests, anything involving personal safety. These jump to the front of the queue and alert an admin immediately — they are never left waiting in a normal queue.

2.1 How a report is filed

Step 1. Customer or provider taps "Report a Problem" on the booking.



Step 2. Picks a category: *Didn't show up / Inappropriate behavior / Suspected fraud / Other*, and writes what happened (photos can be attached as evidence).



Step 3. If the category is "Inappropriate behavior" or anything safety-related, it's automatically marked **Urgent** and an admin is alerted right away. Everything else goes to the normal queue.



Step 4. Admin reviews the report — the booking history, both people's profiles, and any past reports against them — and decides what to do.

2.2 What an admin can do once they review a report

Action	When it's used
Dismiss	Report isn't valid, or was a misunderstanding
Warn the user	Minor issue — a note is added to their record

Refund the customer	E.g. confirmed the provider genuinely never showed up — full refund, no fee, since it wasn't the customer's fault
Block the account	Serious or repeated issue — uses the existing block system (Section 1) — the person is signed out immediately and can't use the app until reviewed again

Example — "Plumber hasn't shown up in 3 days"

Customer accepted an Offer 3 days ago; plumber never came. Customer taps "Report a Problem" → "Didn't show up" → describes the situation.

Admin checks the booking — no OTP was ever verified, no activity from the provider — confirms the story, and processes a **full refund** (treated as the provider's fault, so no cancellation fee applies), and adds a warning to the provider's record.

Example — Inappropriate behavior report

Customer reports that a provider made an inappropriate request during a booking. This is auto-marked **Urgent** — an admin is alerted immediately rather than finding it later in a queue. While it's being reviewed, the reported provider is prevented from taking new bookings. Admin reviews and, if confirmed, blocks the account outright.

2.3 Repeated problems get noticed automatically

Every confirmed report against a user is counted. If the same person keeps getting confirmed reports, admins see this clearly (not just as one-off incidents), making it easy to catch repeat offenders instead of everyone re-investigating from scratch each time.

3. Ratings & Feedback — Full Flow

Today, anyone can technically leave a rating on a service at any time — even without ever booking it. That's being tightened up as part of this feature, and extended to work for every type of booking (not just the old-style ones).

Step 1. A booking reaches `completed` status (job finished, OTP-confirmed).



Step 2. Customer is prompted to rate the provider: ★★★★★ (1 to 5) plus an optional written comment.



Step 3. Only one rating is allowed per booking — no repeat/duplicate ratings, and a rating can only be left for a booking that's genuinely completed (not just any service, any time, like today).



Step 4. The provider's overall rating updates, and this affects where they appear in listings going forward.

Example

Customer's plumber booking completes. App shows: "How was your experience with Marco?" Customer taps 5 stars and writes "Fast and professional, fixed it in 20 minutes." This is saved against that specific booking — Marco cannot be rated again for the same job, and this customer couldn't have rated him before the job was actually done.

3.1 How ratings affect ranking

A provider's average rating becomes one of the factors used to order results — alongside distance and recency, which already matter today. A well-rated provider with lots of completed jobs should naturally surface above a similarly-located but poorly-rated or brand-new one, without completely hiding anyone.

Factor already used today	New factor being added
Distance from customer	Provider's average rating
How recently posted	Number of completed jobs (so one 5-star review from a brand-new provider doesn't automatically outrank someone with hundreds of solid reviews)

Example — two plumbers, same distance

Plumber A: 4.9★ average, 120 completed jobs. Plumber B: 5.0★ average, 2 completed jobs. Both are 2 km away. Plumber A appears first — a slightly lower average backed by many jobs is treated as more trustworthy than a perfect score from only 2 jobs.

3.2 This also works for the new Offer-based requests

When a customer is comparing multiple Offers on a "need a plumber"-style request (the flow covered in the Request Booking Flows document), each provider's rating can be shown right next to their Offer — so the customer isn't just comparing price, they can also see who's reliable.

4. Quick Answers to Common Questions

Q: Can someone rate a provider without ever booking them?

No — a rating can only be submitted for a real completed booking, and only once per booking.

Q: What happens the moment an admin blocks someone?

They're immediately signed out of the app and can't log back in or take any action until an admin unblocks them — this part already works today.

Q: Does reporting someone guarantee they get blocked?

No — every report goes through admin review first. Blocking is one possible outcome, alongside dismissing, warning, or issuing a refund — this protects against false/malicious reports too.

Q: What if the provider genuinely didn't show up — does the customer still lose money to a cancellation fee?

No — once confirmed by an admin, this is treated as the provider's fault, so it's a full refund with no fee, same as any other provider-caused cancellation.

Q: Can a bad rating instantly hide a provider from listings?

No — rating is one ranking factor among several (distance, recency, number of completed jobs), not an on/off switch. A provider only gets blocked through the reporting/admin-review process (Section 2), never automatically from ratings alone.

Q: Does an urgent (safety) report get treated the same as a "didn't show up" report?

No — urgent reports alert an admin immediately and can temporarily prevent the reported person from taking new bookings while it's reviewed, instead of sitting in a normal queue.

5. One-Page Summary

Cheat Sheet

	Reporting & Blocking	Ratings & Rankings
Who triggers it	Customer or provider, via "Report a Problem"	Customer, after a booking completes
Reviewed by	Admin (urgent ones flagged immediately)	Nobody — it's automatic
Possible outcomes	Dismiss / Warn / Refund / Block	Updates the provider's visible average rating
Effect on account	Can lead to a full account block (already-existing mechanism)	Affects ranking in listings, never blocks anyone by itself
Repeat issues	Tracked automatically so repeat offenders stand out	More completed jobs make a rating more trustworthy/weighted

This is a proposal only — nothing has been built yet. Blocking/unblocking itself already exists and needs no new work; this document covers the new reporting flow that feeds into it, and the new rating system that affects listing rank.